

Wisdom is a personality trait that is composed of self-reflection, pro-social behaviors, emotional regulation, acceptance of diverse perspectives, decisiveness, social advising, and spirituality. Wisdom is separable from intelligence. Greater levels of wisdom are linked to better overall health, well-being, happiness, life satisfaction, and resilience. However, the underlying genetic architecture of wisdom and its genetic relationships with health and cognition remain unexplored. We collected responses to SD-WISE-7, a validated survey measure of wisdom, in 131,870 23andMe research-consented participants and conducted the first large-scale genome-wide association study (GWAS) of this trait. We identified one genome-wide significant locus (rs1028640, $P=3.7\text{e-}08$) near the MANEA gene on chromosome 6. Wisdom was heritable ($h^2_{\text{SNP}}=0.03\pm0.004$) and genetically correlated with numerous complex traits, including subjective well-being ($r_g=0.34$, $P=1.52\text{e-}09$), neuroticism ($r_g=-0.38$, $P=1.87\text{e-}16$), loneliness ($r_g=-0.27$, $P=8.45\text{e-}07$), other personality traits such as openness ($r_g=0.41$, $P=1.37\text{e-}07$) and risk tolerance ($r_g=0.36$, $P=6.94\text{e-}11$). Crucially, wisdom was genetically distinct from intelligence ($r_g=0.036$, $P=0.39$) and cognitive educational attainment ($r_g=-0.01$, $P=0.83$). We calculated wisdom polygenic scores (PGS) in All of Us ($N\approx200,000$) and identified significant associations with psychosocial outcomes (e.g., social satisfaction ratings $P=1.16\text{e-}12$ and subjective mental health $P=5.93\text{e-}10$), but not cognitive performance ($p=xx$). This study advances our understanding of wisdom as a biologically-grounded trait that could ultimately be used to develop informed interventions that increase wisdom and improve health and well-being.